Provide a list of dates of key events involving the possible use of nuclear weapons by Russia in Ukraine

Here is a list of key dates involving the possible or threatened use of nuclear weapons by Russia in the context of the Ukraine conflict:

- 21 February 2022: Russia recognized the Donetsk and Luhansk People's Republics as independent states, a precursor to the invasion, with accusations by Putin about nuclear threats from Ukraine and NATO.[1]
- 24 February 2022: Russia launched a military offensive against Ukraine. Putin issued a warning implying severe consequences for those hindering Russia, interpreted by some as hinting at nuclear escalation.[2] [1]
- 21 September 2022: During a partial mobilization announcement, Putin said Russia "will use all the means at our disposal," widely interpreted as a nuclear threat. Russian officials, including Sergey Lavrov and Dmitry Medvedev, made statements not ruling out nuclear weapon use to defend annexed territories.[3] [4] [5]
- 1 October 2022: Ramzan Kadyrov called on Russia to use low-yield nuclear weapons in Ukraine, responding to a significant Russian loss in Lyman. Kremlin stated nuclear use decisions would follow military doctrine, not emotions.[4] [5] [3]
- 2023 and beyond: Russia continued military actions with repeated missile strikes on civilian infrastructure affecting energy and nuclear facilities, but no confirmed nuclear weapon use. The International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) has maintained a presence monitoring nuclear plants, including after a drone strike on Chernobyl's New Safe Confinement in February 2025.[6]

These represent moments of heightened nuclear threat or disaster-risking incidents related to nuclear facilities, but no confirmed use of nuclear weapons by Russia in Ukraine has occurred up to late 2025.[6] [3] [4] [2]

This summary includes the key dates of nuclear weapon threats or risk events involving Russia and Ukraine.

Provide a detailed list of dates of key events involving the possible use of nuclear weapons by Russia in Ukraine during 2022

Here is a detailed list of key dates in 2022 involving the possible use or threat of nuclear weapons by Russia in the Ukraine conflict:

- February 21-22, 2022: Russian President Putin warned that Ukraine seeking tactical nuclear weapons posed a "strategic threat" to Russia, heightening nuclear tensions.[11]
- February 24, 2022: On the day Russia launched its full-scale invasion of Ukraine, Putin issued a warning that those who try to hinder Russia will face "consequences never seen in history," widely interpreted as a nuclear threat. On the same day, Ukraine informed the IAEA that Russian forces had taken control of the Chernobyl nuclear power plant.[12] [13] [11]
- February 27, 2022: Putin ordered Russia's nuclear forces to a "special mode of combat duty," a status facilitating rapid launch orders of nuclear weapons, signaling heightened nuclear readiness.[13]
- March 4, 2022: Zaporizhzhia nuclear power plant, the largest in Europe, came under attack and was taken over by Russian forces, raising international concerns about nuclear safety though no nuclear weapon was used.[12]
- Late March 2022: Russia’s nuclear threats and rhetoric continued as forces solidified control in eastern Ukraine and withdrew from around Kyiv.[14]
- August 2022: During the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) Review Conference, Russia publicly declared nuclear war "should never be unleashed" but denied threatening nuclear use.[14]
- September 21, 2022: Putin announced partial mobilization and explicitly warned Russia would use "all means at our disposal," interpreted as a direct nuclear threat. Foreign Minister Lavrov stated nuclear weapons could be used to defend annexed Ukrainian territories.[15] [14]
- Late September 2022: Russia resumed menacing nuclear rhetoric as Ukrainian counteroffensives advanced in Kharkiv and Kherson regions.[14]
- October 1, 2022: Ramzan Kadyrov called for using low-yield nuclear weapons in response to Russian territorial losses; Kremlin replied nuclear use decisions would follow doctrine, not emotions.[15]

These events mark the major moments in 2022 involving Russia's nuclear threats or nuclear-related incidents in the Ukraine war. No nuclear weapons were used, but the rhetoric and actions raised global alarm about possible nuclear escalation.[13] [12] [15] [14]

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Provide a detailed list of dates of key events involving the possible use of nuclear weapons by Russia in Ukraine during 2022 and include the American response

Here is a detailed list of key dates in 2022 involving the possible use or threat of nuclear weapons by Russia in Ukraine, with the corresponding American responses:

- February 21-22, 2022: Before the invasion, Putin warned about Ukraine seeking tactical nuclear weapons, signaling a strategic threat. The US monitored these nuclear tensions closely as part of the escalating crisis.[21]
- February 24, 2022: On the day Russia launched the invasion, Putin warned of consequences never seen in history if impeded, widely interpreted as a nuclear threat. Russia ordered its nuclear forces to a heightened state of combat readiness. The US condemned the invasion and increased intelligence monitoring of Russian nuclear posture.[22] [23]
- February 27, 2022: Putin ordered Russia's nuclear forces into a "special mode of combat duty," increasing readiness to launch nuclear weapons rapidly. The US Department of Defense publicly monitored and assessed this move as an escalation, but did not change alert levels.[24]
- April 24-25, 2022: After US Secretary of State Antony Blinken met Ukrainian President Zelenskyy in Kyiv, Russian Foreign Minister Lavrov warned that further Western support risked a World War III scenario. US officials, including Secretary of Defense Lloyd Austin, called Russia's nuclear rhetoric "dangerous and unhelpful," emphasizing peaceful conflict resolution.[24]
- September 21, 2022: Putin announced partial mobilization and warned he would use "all means at our disposal," widely interpreted as a nuclear threat, alongside accusations of NATO nuclear blackmail. The US and NATO publicly condemned these threats, increased support to Ukraine, and heightened deterrence measures.[25] [24]
- October 1, 2022: Chechen leader Ramzan Kadyrov called for low-yield nuclear weapon use in Ukraine. Kremlin responded that nuclear decisions adhere to doctrine, not emotions. The US denounced such nuclear threats and reiterated commitment to Ukraine's defense without nuclear escalations.[25]

Throughout 2022, American intelligence monitored Russian nuclear force status and rhetoric closely, publicly condemning nuclear threats and working with NATO allies to deter escalation while supporting Ukraine with military aid.[26] [23] [22] [24] [25]

No confirmed use of nuclear weapons occurred, but the US response aimed to contain the crisis and inhibit any nuclear escalation through diplomatic, military, and intelligence channels.

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Provide this information for October 2022 only

In October 2022, key events involving the possible use or threat of nuclear weapons by Russia in Ukraine and the American response included:

- October 1, 2022: Ramzan Kadyrov, head of the Chechen Republic and Russian ally, called for Russia to use low-yield nuclear weapons in Ukraine following Russia's loss of the strategic town of Lyman. The Kremlin responded that decisions about nuclear weapon use would follow Russian military doctrine, not emotions, signaling no immediate change in nuclear posture.[31] [32]
- October 23–28, 2022: Russian officials launched an intense information campaign claiming Ukraine was close to developing a dirty bomb (a radiological weapon). These claims were perceived as disinformation intended to justify potential Russian nuclear escalation or delegitimize Ukraine internationally in the wake of Russian battlefield setbacks. This period coincided with large-scale Russian nuclear exercises and heightened nuclear signaling.[33] [34]
- October 27, 2022: At the Valdai Club meeting, Putin reiterated Russia's claim that Ukraine planned to use a dirty bomb to accuse Russia of nuclear attack but declared that Russia itself had no need to use nuclear weapons in Ukraine, denying any intention of nuclear use at that point. On the same day, U.S. Secretary of Defense Lloyd Austin warned that any use of nuclear weapons would provoke a "very significant response" by the United States and its allies, emphasizing the gravity of escalation.[33]
- October 28, 2022: Dmitry Polyansky, Russia's first deputy permanent representative to the UN, gave a final public warning about the alleged Ukrainian dirty bomb aimed at provoking Western intervention. After this date, Russian statements about the dirty bomb ceased. The U.S. maintained strong diplomatic and military support for Ukraine while continuing public warnings about the consequences of nuclear escalation.[33]

Throughout October 2022, the U.S. response combined vigilance and deterrence—monitoring Russia’s nuclear rhetoric and capability closely, providing military aid to Ukraine, condemning nuclear threats diplomatically, and signaling readiness to respond decisively in case of nuclear weapon use.[34] [31] [33]

This period represented one of the most intense phases of nuclear signaling and psychological warfare in the conflict, marked by Russia's use of nuclear rhetoric and disinformation alongside direct threats from allied officials, met by firm U.S. diplomatic warnings and commitments to Ukraine's defense.[31] [34] [33]

No nuclear weapons were used by Russia in October 2022 or thereafter, but the heightened rhetoric underscored ongoing risks of escalation.[34] [33]

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